

Table 8.3. Comparison of Cameron, Mitchell, and Annie's investments

Investor	Total money invested	Age when started investing	Total at age 65
Cameron	\$120,000	25	\$1,262,089
Mitchell	\$120,000	35	\$641,582
Annie	\$120,000	45	\$326,147

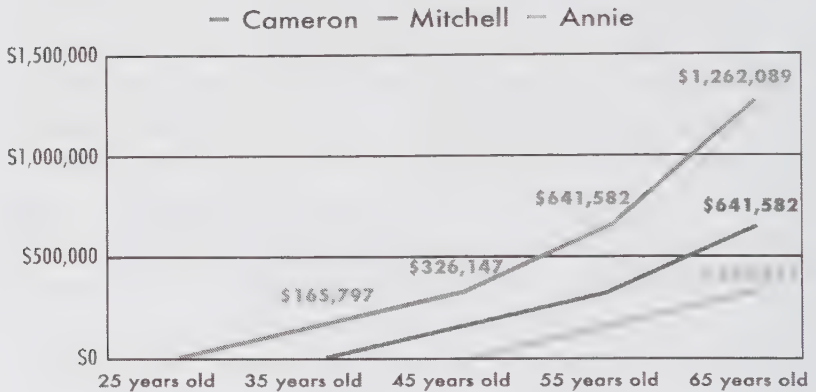


Figure 8.4. Comparison of Cameron, Mitchell, and Annie's investments

This example makes very clear the benefits of investing early. All three invested the exact same amount of money with the same strategy. The only thing Cameron did differently was get started sooner. Cameron has twice as much money as Mitchell and nearly four times as much money as Annie simply because she started early. Even if you can only invest a little, get started as soon as you can to take advantage of compound interest.